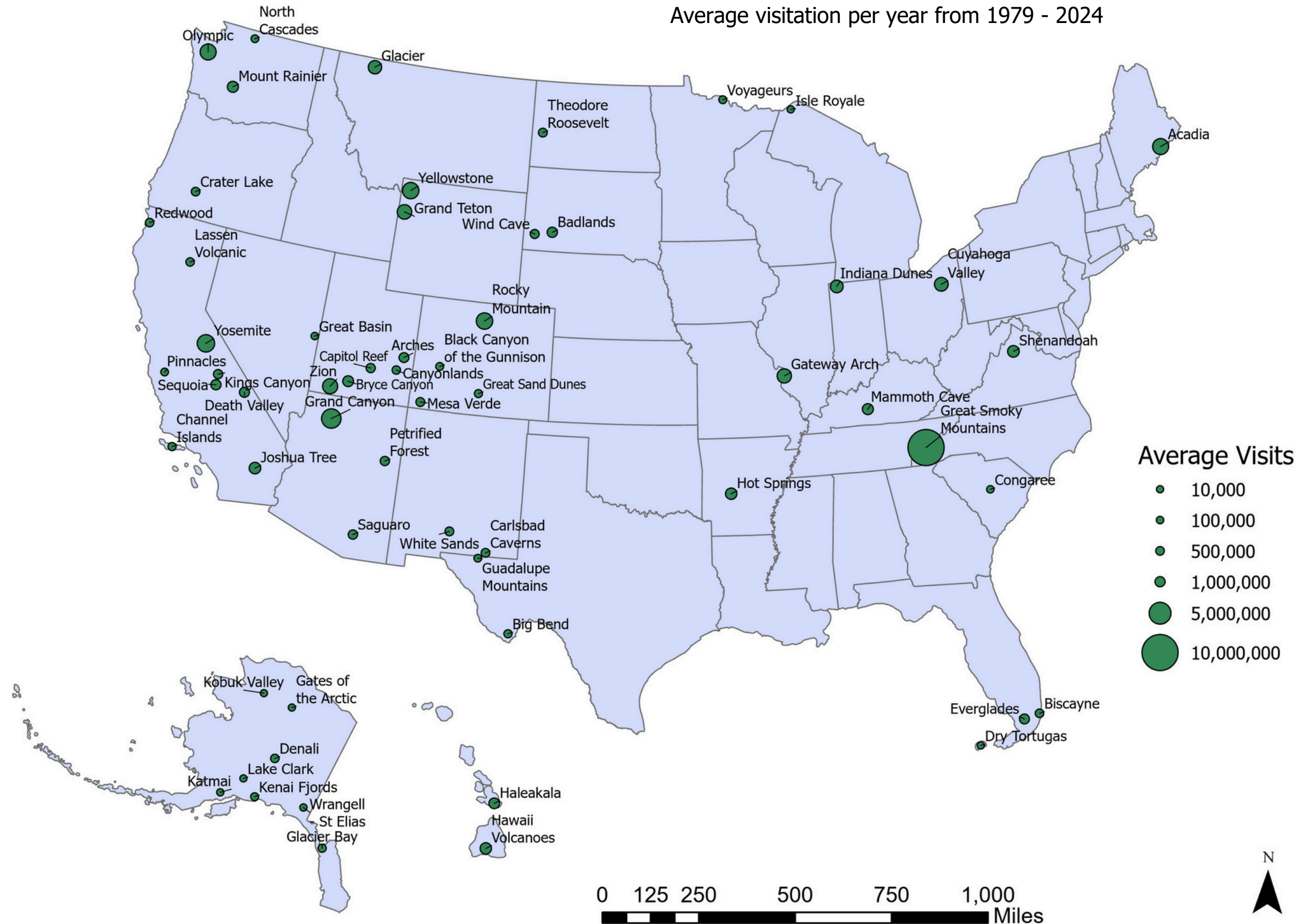


Most Visited National Parks

Average visitation per year from 1979 - 2024



Purpose

To inform viewers about different park visitation rates, so they can decide to visit the least busiest parks if they want.

Audience

Anyone who is planning a trip to a National Park (or several).
Or anyone who wants to analyze trends in park visitation

Software Used

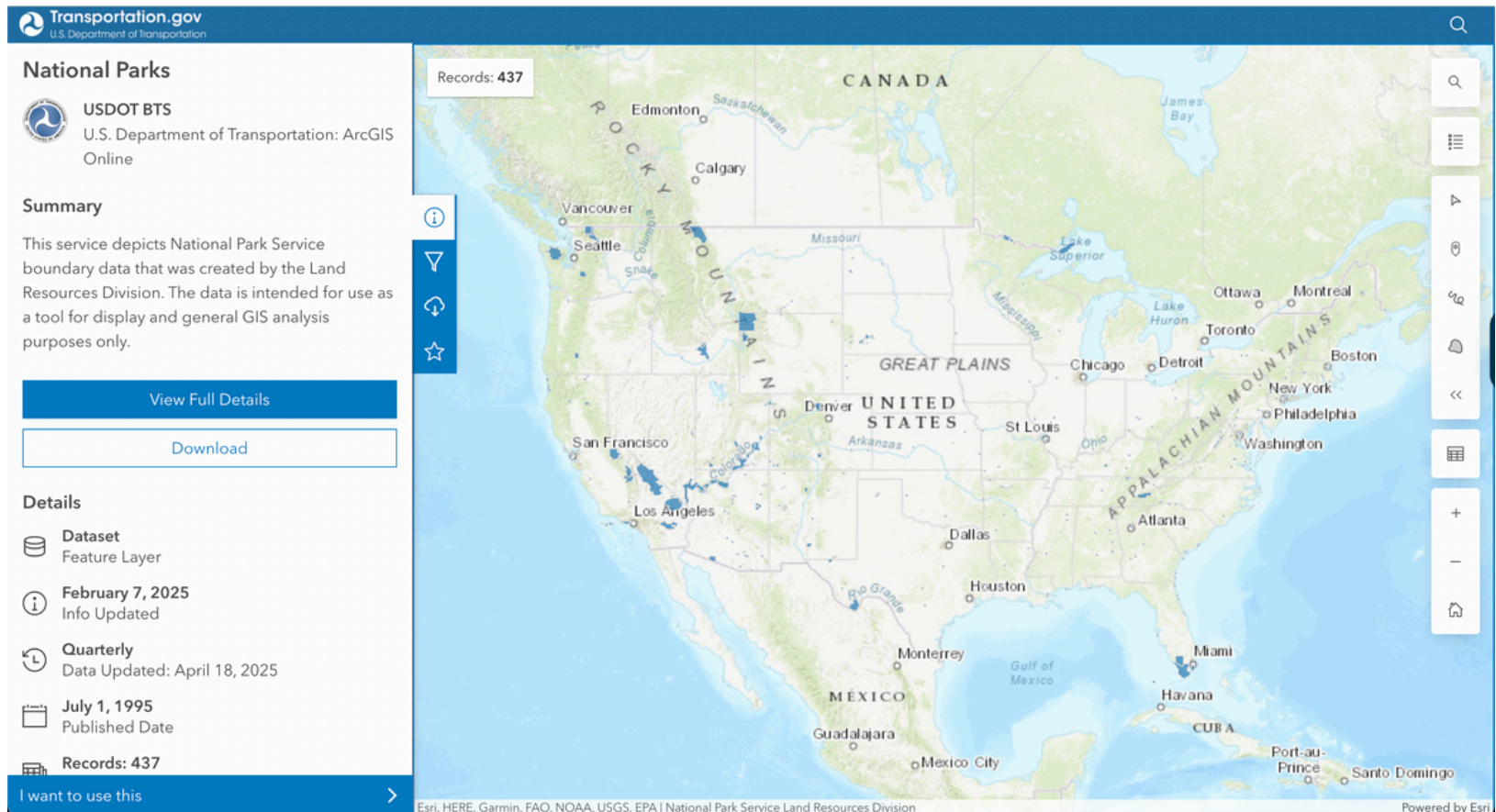
ArcGIS Pro
R Studio
Canva

Methods

- 1. Insert nps_boundaries shape file
- 2. Geoprocessing tool = (Project) to new coordinate system (North American albers equal area conic)
- 3. Then we want to turn the boundaries into points to make it look better for the maps intention: Geoprocessing tool = (feature to point)
- 4. Narrow down attribute table to just NPS in the US: Select by feature & create a new layer
- 5. Add the “tl_2023_us_state.shp” and project
- 6. Now lets clip the nps points to the usa outline just to make sure we don’t have any scraglers
- 7. Use R to average data...
- 8. Back in Arc, join average visitation with nps boundary points.
- 9. Symbolize by proportional symbols
- 10. Label and create layout
- 11. Use R to create histogram / use canva to create other cool graphs

Data

National Parks - USDOT
US-National-Parks_RecreationVisits_1979-2024.csv
TIGER - USA Shapefile



National Parks - USDOT

Select dataset				
US-National-Parks_Recreat				
ParkName	Region	State	Year	RecreationVisits
Search	Search	Search	Search	Search
Acadia NP	Northeast	ME	1979	2.8M
Acadia NP	Northeast	ME	1980	2.8M
Acadia NP	Northeast	ME	1981	3.0M
Acadia NP	Northeast	ME	1982	3.6M
Acadia NP	Northeast	ME	1983	4.1M
Acadia NP	Northeast	ME	1984	3.7M
Acadia NP	Northeast	ME	1985	3.7M
Acadia NP	Northeast	ME	1986	3.9M
Acadia NP	Northeast	ME	1987	4.3M
Acadia NP	Northeast	ME	1988	4.5M
Acadia NP	Northeast	ME	1989	5.4M
Acadia NP	Northeast	ME	1990	2.3M
Acadia NP	Northeast	ME	1991	2.5M
Acadia NP	Northeast	ME	1992	2.4M
Acadia NP	Northeast	ME	1993	2.7M
Acadia NP	Northeast	ME	1994	2.7M
Acadia NP	Northeast	ME	1995	2.8M
Acadia NP	Northeast	ME	1996	2.7M
Acadia NP	Northeast	ME	1997	2.8M
Page Size				100000
				First Prev 1 Next Last
DOWNLOAD DATA				

US-National-Parks_RecreationVisits_1979-2024.csv

unit_code	park_name	state	AvgVisits
ACAD	Acadia	ME	3001627.152
ARCH	Arches	UT	894382.8913
BADL	Badlands	SD	1022875.587
BIBE	Big Bend	TX	326903.3478
BISC	Biscayne	FL	463649
BLCA	Black Canyon of the Gunnison	CO	245845.5435
BRCA	Bryce Canyon	UT	1233760.565
CANY	Canyonlands	UT	419784.9783
CARE	Capitol Reef	UT	682313.7174
CAVE	Carlsbad Caverns	NM	538724.4783
CHIS	Channel Islands	CA	312260.2826
CONG	Congaree	SC	103145.775
CRLA	Crater Lake	OR	486658.5
CUVA	Cuyahoga Valley	OH	2211137.696
DENA	Denali	AK	431212.6739
DEVA	Death Valley	CA	948566.9348
DRTO	Dry Tortugas	FL	47996.5
EVER	Everglades	FL	922629.7391
GAAR	Gates of the Arctic	AK	6970.744186
GLAC	Glacier	MT	2095725.435
GLBA	Glacier Bay	AK	334073.7826
GRBA	Great Basin	NV	86826.69565
GRCA	Grand Canyon	AZ	4161919.826
GRSA	Great Sand Dunes	CO	298985.5217
GRSM	Great Smoky Mountains	NC	9822658.326
GRTE	Grand Teton	WY	2509523.935
GUMO	Guadalupe Mountains	TX	182275.9783
HALE	Haleakala	HI	1179257.522
HAVO	Hawaii Volcanoes	HI	1411694.696
HOSP	Hot Springs	AR	1432560.804

Data Table

INDU	Indiana Dunes	IN	1871785.652
ISRO	Isle Royale	MI	20314.13043
JEFF	Gateway Arch	IL	2419498.652
JOTR	Joshua Tree	CA	1482932.804
KATM	Katmai	AK	40159.84444
KEFJ	Kenai Fjords	AK	227288.5581
KICA	Kings Canyon	CA	685076.3043
KOVA	Kobuk Valley	AK	6450.162791
LACL	Lake Clark	AK	11510.02326
LAVO	Lassen Volcanic	CA	418994.1087
MACA	Mammoth Cave	KY	1281422.609
MEVE	Mesa Verde	CO	565156.8913
MORA	Mount Rainier	WA	1307281.891
NOCA	North Cascades	WA	195927.8478
OLYM	Olympic	WA	3003451.609
PEFO	Petrified Forest	AZ	694281.1087
PINN	Pinnacles	CA	200763.7609
REDW	Redwood	CA	448139.0217
ROMO	Rocky Mountain	CO	3137569.196
SAGU	Saguaro	AZ	729941.7391
SEQU	Sequoia	CA	1009114.478
SHEN	Shenandoah	VA	1524167.304
THRO	Theodore Roosevelt	ND	536510.0435
VOYA	Voyageurs	MN	221786.913
WHSА	White Sands	NM	549837.4348
WICA	Wind Cave	SD	611498.5217
WRST	Wrangell - St Elias	AK	49340.62791
YELL	Yellowstone	ID	3133457.217
YOSE	Yosemite	CA	3474583.13
ZION	Zion	UT	2697031.913

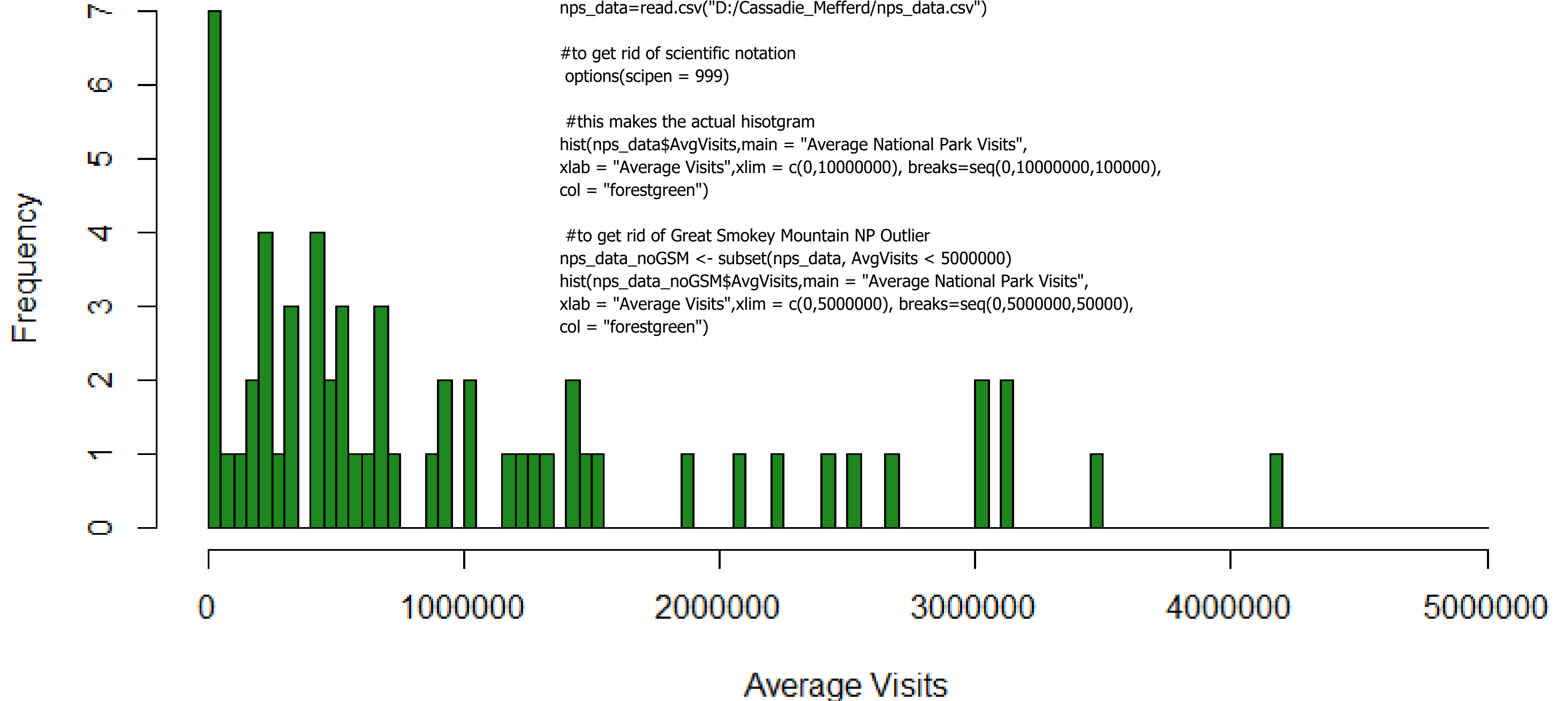
Average National Park Visits

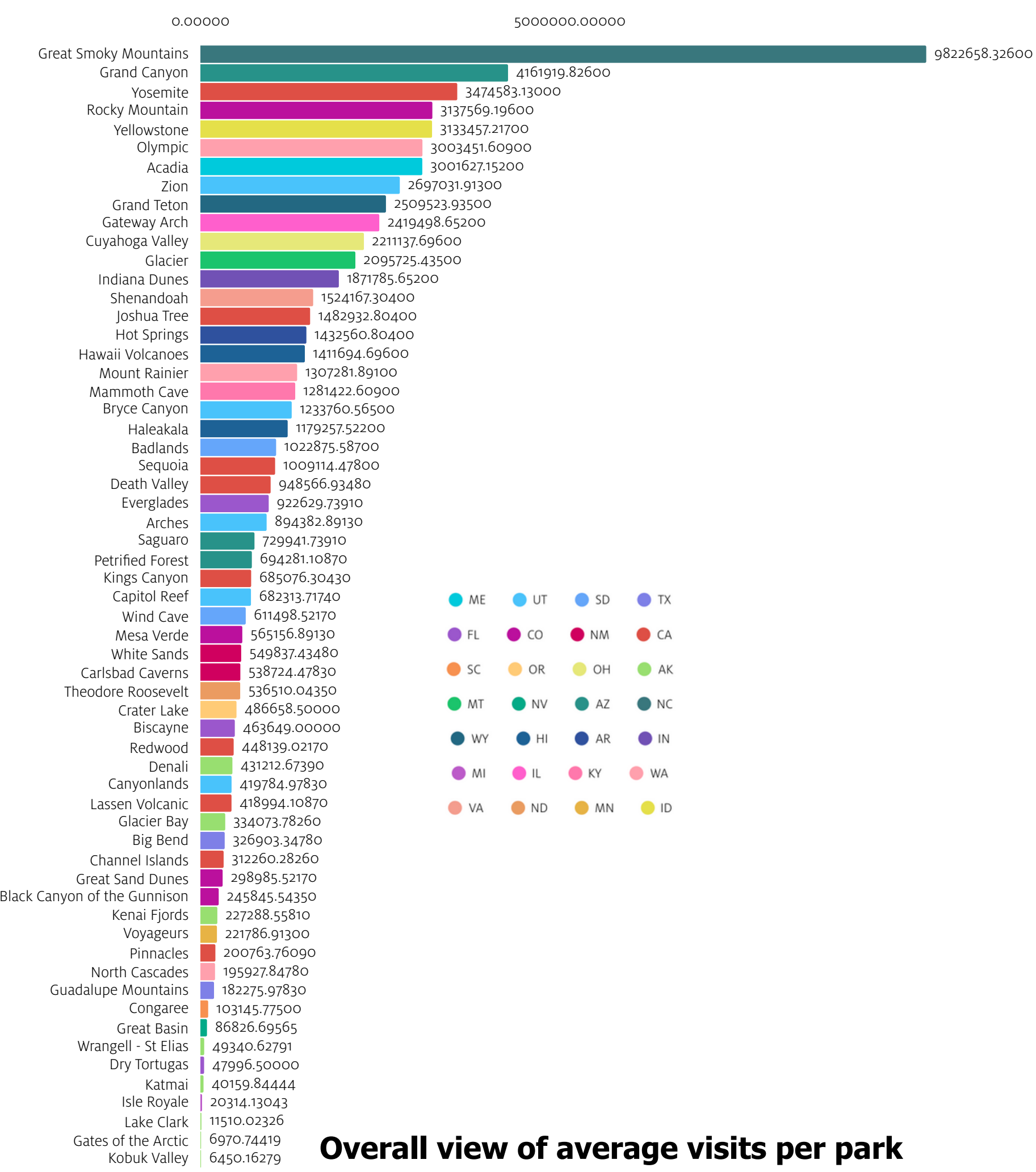
```
#to create a histogram with R Studio
nps_data=read.csv("D:/Cassadie_Mefferd/nps_data.csv")

#to get rid of scientific notation
options(scipen = 999)

#this makes the actual hisotgram
hist(nps_data$AvgVisits,main = "Average National Park Visits",
xlab = "Average Visits",xlim = c(0,10000000), breaks=seq(0,10000000,100000),
col = "forestgreen")

#to get rid of Great Smokey Mountain NP Outlier
nps_data_noGSM <- subset(nps_data, AvgVisits < 5000000)
hist(nps_data_noGSM$AvgVisits,main = "Average National Park Visits",
xlab = "Average Visits",xlim = c(0,5000000), breaks=seq(0,5000000,50000),
col = "forestgreen")
```





Overall view of average visits per park

